



Google TV gets two new features
Google TV now allows personalized profiles and smart recommendations to its services. <https://digit.in/jul22-01>



AI growing without governance
AI is being adopted more and more as days go by but without human expertise to benefit businesses. <https://digit.in/jul22-02>

End of an IE-ra

“Our dead are never dead to us until we have forgotten them”
– George Eliot

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It finally happened. The day we all knew would eventually come is here, and it's a bittersweet

goodbye to Internet Explorer, as Microsoft has finally and officially pulled the plug. And yes, I know it's common for people to hate on it, and the memes are all negative, and one would expect me, the king of hating on things, to follow suit, but I find myself unable to.

IE was my very first window into the WWW. Sure I'd connected to networks before and used bulletin board systems and IRC, but IE was my window into the rich content that would eventually become the norm for us all. Sure, I flirted with Opera, Netscape and others for a long while. But IE was like the faithful old wife, always willing to forgive my sins of infidelity with the hot new browsers on the block, as I shamelessly found my way back home when it came to doing something important. Such as filling out job applications or using certain sites that somehow only worked on IE at the time.

I get the apathy people have about the news. Kids who have been born into the world of streaming video and social media probably don't care about the history of browsers, or even know that some cutthroat browser wars occurred in the past. And they certainly don't appreciate the power

that a humble browser possesses, even today.

Most of the kids on reddit who made mocking memes about the final laying to rest of IE aren't even as old as the browser they're bashing! After all, 27 years is a very long time in technology history.

Some of the obituaries written were just insanely silly though. Nothing screams HYPOCRITE more than Google Chrome fanboys rejoicing on Reddit and Twitter about the death of IE. In their own words, “IE was Microsoft's way of establishing a monopoly over the internet!” Such a brave stance to take, right? The “minority” who use a browser that has (checks stats) 88.3 per cent of browser market share in India! Globally, Safari is its closest competitor at 19 per cent (Chrome is 65 per cent globally). Still



maintain that Microsoft was the evil, greedy company while Apple and Google are considered heroes for their monopolies! 🐼

A quick history lesson: When IE first came into existence in 1995, Netscape Navigator had an 83 per cent monopoly. IE rose quickly through the ranks, and became the most popular browser in 1998. By 2003, IE had a 95 per cent stranglehold on the browser space. In 2004, Firefox 1.0 was released, and it quickly killed off Netscape Navigator by early 2004. In 2008 Chrome was released and grew rapidly thanks to the backing of Google. Apple was also gaining market share, but only based on the sheer popularity of their own devices after the iPhone launch in 2007. By the end of 2010, Microsoft's monopoly had been cut to 50 per cent, and it seemed like Firefox (30 per cent at the time) would become #1. As it turns out, that was the highest market share Firefox would ever get, as Chrome started enticing away not just IE users, but Firefox users as well. By 2012 Chrome was the most popular browser, and by 2015 IE had fallen below Firefox into third place. By 2019 IE had fallen even below Safari, and today, the IE market share is some decimal percentage that's insignificant. Microsoft Edge is the third most used browser with 4 per cent market share, with Firefox coming in fourth at 3.2 per cent. (Source: Statcounter.com). In India, thanks to our Android obsession, Chrome has nearly 90 per cent market share.

And let me be totally honest, I'm a Chrome user most of the time too, I also have Firefox installed, but I don't use it as often. I find myself shuttling between Chrome and Edge. Just last month I did have to start up a Windows XP virtual machine, because a friend needed to use IE in order to access the legacy-code-driven, tender server of a company in the middle east. Yes, the death of IE means that a not-so-insignificant number of companies around the globe will have to spend money to upgrade their systems to get with the times. 🇮🇳